

3.1.3 Area of study 2 – Live theatre production

Students must learn how to analyse and evaluate the work of live theatre makers (performers and/or designers).

Students should aim to understand productions in terms of the relevant content listed in [Knowledge and understanding](#) (page 11) and in addition consider:

- how the play has been interpreted in the production seen and what messages the company might be trying to communicate
- the skills demonstrated by the performers and how successfully meaning was communicated to the audience by the performers
- the design skills demonstrated in the production and how successfully meaning was communicated to the audience through design.

To aid their analysis students should carry out background research into the production.

They may read the play and reviews of the production and should develop an understanding of:

- the plot and characters
- specific features or hallmarks of the style/genre of the production
- the context of the play/production.

Live theatre could include:

- plays
- physical theatre
- theatre in education
- musical theatre.

Productions may be professional or amateur (not peer).

Students certificating after 1 January 2019 are required to experience live performance – in which they are a member of the audience in the same performance space as the performers. This may be a professional or amateur, but not a peer, performance. Schools/colleges must submit a 'Live Performance Statement' (which will be available on our website) to confirm that all students have completed this requirement. Failure to provide this statement prior to 1 May in the year of certification will be treated as maladministration. Students may still complete the 'Live theatre production' section of the exam paper referring to digital recordings or streamed productions.

Teachers must ensure that students see at least one performance which will enable them to access all of the Section C exam questions and the mark scheme in full. This performance must:

- be a minimum of 50 minutes in duration excluding any intervals or breaks
- include at least two actors
- include dialogue
- include a range of production values (lighting, sound, set and costume).

Students must not answer Section B and Section C of the exam on the same play ie the live production seen cannot be their set play.